



SKO March 2026, Boston

Red Zone Selling Workshop

Winning Deals with Structure, Control, and Execution

A proven framework for BlueSnap Sellers to close mid-market and enterprise deals with precision and confidence.

About Vince Beese

- **25+ Years in Sales Leadership** – CRO 3x, VP 6x, Fractional CRO, Coach
- **5x Successful Exits** – Helped scale companies from startup to acquisition
- **\$1 Billion+ in Revenue Generated** across enterprise sales
- **Bestselling Author of *Red Zone Selling*** – The ultimate playbook for high-performing sellers
- **Built & Scaled Teams at** LivePerson, CheetahMail, SugarCRM, True Fit, Kustomer, Meta
- **Founder & Workshop Leader** – Equipping teams to execute and win with Red Zone Selling
- **Passionate Sales Pro** – Dedicated to elevating the sales profession and building closers



Workshop Agenda & Logistics

March 4, 2026 | 9:30 AM – 12:40 PM

→ **9:30 – 10:00 AM**

Welcome + Red Zone Setup

→ **10:00 – 10:40 AM**

Yellow Zone: Pain Alignment & Power Mapping

→ **10:40 – 11:20 AM**

Green Zone: Mutual Action Plan & Multi-Threading

→ **11:20 AM – 12:00 PM**

Red Zone: Close & Approval Clarity

→ **12:00 – 12:30 PM**

Deal Breakdowns

→ **12:30 – 12:40 PM**

Close & Commitments

Prepare for a focused 3-hour session of intensive learning and practical application to elevate your sales game.

Why are you here today?

"You didn't come here to sit through another workshop. So what brought you?"

What deal keeps you up at night?

The one you can't stop thinking about.
The one that should be closed by now.
What's actually going on with it?

What pattern do you keep seeing that you want to break?

The same stall. The same ghosting.
The same "we need more time." What's the cycle you're stuck in?

What would make today worth your time?

You have 3 hours. What's the one thing you need to walk out with — a framework, a shift, a plan — to make this count?

 **The next 3 hours are about fixing what's broken in your pipeline. Let's make it count.**

BlueSnap: Our Challenges & Goals

To win more, we need to sell differently. Here's what's standing between us and a 10% lift in win rate.

Close Ratio Gap

Increase our close ratio **by 10%** this year. Every deal we lose to inaction or poor execution is a missed target.

Single-Threaded Risk

Too many deals rely on one contact. When that contact goes dark, the deal dies. We need to **multi-thread** every opportunity.

Executive Urgency & Value

We're not getting high enough, fast enough. Driving urgency and **value alignment** with decision-makers is non-negotiable.

Commodity Trap

"You're all the same — just give me the best price." We must **differentiate on value**, not compete on price.

Red Zone is About Doing, Not Theory

What We Won't Do

Sit through slides. Talk in hypotheticals. Leave without a plan. This is a working session designed for operators who want results.

What We'll Do

Work on your actual deals in real time. Apply one high-impact play per zone. Walk out with concrete next steps you can execute this week.

Today is about collaboration and a willingness to learn. One thing!

Why Red Zone Selling Matters

The Problem

Most deals were never Opportunities to begin with.

- Starts with Weak Qualification
- Turns into low Urgency momentum
- Leading to Low interaction & Ghosting
- And ultimately Stalled or Lost Deals

The Solution

A Selling System for Closing Deals

- From Qualification to Close (Yellow, Green, Red)
- Accountability and ownership
- Providing a framework and Plays to win
- A Roadmap to Forecast with Confidence

The Red Zone Selling System

Like a QB advancing down the field, you'll move your deals through three critical zones. Master each zone, and you'll close more deals with greater consistency.

1

Yellow Zone

Qualification

Is this a real opportunity or just noise?
Separate the prospects from the suspects. This is where deals go to die.

2

Green Zone

Momentum

Are you building alignment or watching the deal stall? Keep the drive alive and moving forward.

3

Red Zone

Closing

Can you finish strong when the pressure peaks? Execute in the moments that matter most.

Every deal lives somewhere in those three zones. The best sellers always know where they are, read the field, adapt the play, and finish the drive.

Workshop Operating Model



Teach

Learn the core plays, frameworks, and pressure-tested questions for each zone.



Apply

Apply plays to your real pipeline deals. Build templates, maps, and plans in real-time.



Review

Pressure-test your work with peers and coaches. Surface blind spots and refine your approach.

Expectations for participants: Bring at least two active deals across different zones. Participate fully in exercises. Challenge assumptions—yours and others'. This is a safe space to expose gaps before they cost you deals.



Let's Get into the Yellow Zone!
4F Deal Fit & Power Mapping

Yellow Zone Overview

The Yellow Zone is where deals are qualified and foundations are built. This is early to mid-funnel, before you've secured buying alignment. Most sellers rush through this zone, eager to get to a demo or proposal.

That's a mistake. Deals that skip Yellow Zone rigor end up stalling in the Green or Red Zone. You can't create urgency if you don't understand friction. You can't close a champion if you're single-threaded.

Common Yellow Zone Mistakes

- Pitching solutions before understanding buying dynamics
- Overvaluing title and undervaluing influence
- Assuming budget exists instead of confirming it
- Building timelines based on hope, not evidence
- Advancing deals prematurely

Yellow Zone Play 1: 4F Deal Fit

Purpose

Decide if the deal is worth pursuing. Not every opportunity deserves your time. The 4F Play forces objective evaluation before you invest resources.

When to Run It

After initial discovery calls, before building a proposal or delivering a demo. Re-run whenever deal conditions change.

1

Fit

Does their **Problem** match our solution's core value? Can we deliver measurable impact?

2

Friction

What **Pain** are they experiencing right now? Who owns it?
What happens if they don't solve it?

3

Funding

Has **Budget** been allocated? Who controls it? What's the approval process?

4

Forecast

Do they have a **Real timeline** driven by a business event? Or is this exploratory?

Red flag: If two or more Fs are weak, the deal is likely a time-waster. Either disqualify or invest in strengthening the Fs before progressing.
[Chapter 2, page 22 in your book] [Use the Friction Preload Play - for urgency - Time, Value, ROE, page 51]

Yellow Zone Play 2: Power Mapping

Early-stage deals fail when we guess at power instead of mapping it. Single-threaded deals are fragile deals. Power Mapping gives you the full picture of who matters and why.



Identify all stakeholders

Don't stop at your Champion—find the Economic Buyer, Technical Buyer, and End Users



Map authority vs. influence

High authority makes final calls. High influence shapes decisions without signing.



Validate your map

Run the "Guess → Ask → Confirm" loop to test what you think you know

Understanding Key Buyer Roles



Champion

Sells internally on your behalf. Has influence but often lacks final authority. Your primary relationship and advocate.



Economic Buyer

Controls budget and makes the final purchase decision. May not be hands-on but must say yes for the deal to close.



Technical Buyer

Evaluates if your solution actually works—security, IT, compliance. Can block deals with technical objections.



User

Day-to-day operator who lives in your product. Their feedback matters—especially if they resist change.



Executive Sponsor

Senior leader who provides strategic approval and removes organizational roadblocks. Often the final signature or key influencer at the top.



Legal (Operations)

Reviews contracts, terms, and compliance requirements. Can slow or block deals if not engaged early.



Procurement

Manages vendor relationships, negotiates pricing, and enforces purchasing policies. Controls the contracting process.



Finance (CFO office)

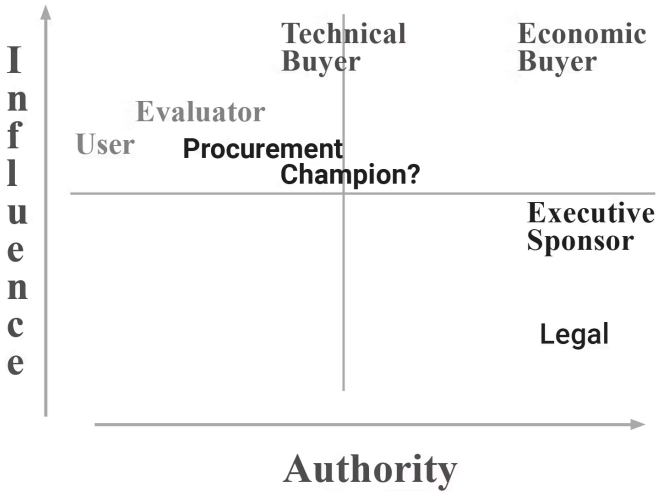
Approves budget allocation and ensures financial justification. Validates ROI and business case.

Mapping w/ High Authority and Influence

MAPPING THE KEY STAKEHOLDERS INTERNALLY

Name	Title	Role	Strategic Position	Authority	Influence	Coverage
John Smith	VP of CX	Champion	Promoter	High	High	Mary
Jill Olsen	User	Influencer	Promoter	Low	Medium	Jim
Bill Lynn	IT Dir	Technical Buyer	Threat	Medium	Medium	Sue
Sallie Mae	SVP	Economic Buyer	Neutral	High	High	Vince

HIGH AUTHORITY & INFLUENCE



Identify and Engage Key Stakeholders to increase your chances of closing. Multithreading for the win!

Multi-threading for the Win

Real statistics tell the truth on why you need more than just a Champion!

5X

Win Rate

Multi-threading improves win rate **5x (480%)** (usergems.com).

57%

Increased Deal Size

Multi-threading boosts deal size by **57%** (usergems.com).

3X

More People

Closed-won deals involve **3x the number of people** compared to lost deals (Federico Presicci).

Exercise: Map Your Yellow Zone Deal

📄 **Pick a real early-stage deal from your pipeline.** Open your CRM. Grab the Key Stakeholder Mapping Template. Let's build this live.

- List everyone involved in the buying decision—names and titles
- Assign each person a role: Champion, Economic Buyer, Technical Buyer, or User
- Mark which stakeholders you've actually spoken to vs. assumed roles
- Identify the biggest gap: Who do you need to meet next?

You have 15–20 minutes. Go.

Yellow Zone Review: Reflect and Refine

| "Who do you need to meet next and how will you get there?"

Let's hear it:

What stakeholders do you need to identify and engage?

Who's Champion is also the Economic Buyer?

Did anyone have all key stakeholders mapped and engaged?

What role is hardest to get involved in your deals?





Let's Get into the Green Zone!
Friction Preload Play & Mutual Action Plans

Green Zone Overview

The Green Zone is where deals build momentum or stall indefinitely. You've qualified the opportunity, delivered your demo, and the prospect seems interested. Now comes the hard part: **converting interest into action**.

This is where most deals die a slow death. Prospects say they're excited but can't commit to next steps. Champions promise internal selling but never follow through. Decision timelines slip week after week, quarter after quarter.

Signs of Fake Progress

- "We're really excited about this"
- "I'll get back to you next week"
- "We need to socialize internally"
- "This is definitely a priority"
- "I got a good feeling about this one"

Signs of Real Momentum

- Specific dates with business justification
- Documented action items with owners
- Champion actively introducing you to stakeholders
- Prospect investing time in proof of concept
- Responsive bi-directional interactions

Green Zone Play 1: The Friction Preload

Urgency doesn't magically appear—you create it by surfacing friction early. The Friction Preload Play uses probing questions to make implicit costs explicit before you reach the Red Zone.



Time-Based Urgency

What business event or deadline makes solving this problem time-sensitive?

- What happens if this isn't solved by [date]?
- Who gets impacted if implementation delays?
- Are there compliance or regulatory deadlines?



Value-Based Urgency

What is the cost of inaction measured in dollars, productivity, or risk?

- How much does this problem cost per week?
- What opportunities are you missing right now?
- If this continues for another quarter, what's the financial impact?



ROI-Based Urgency

How quickly can they realize value, and what does delayed value cost?

- When do you need to see ROI to justify the investment?
- How long does implementation take before you see results?
- What's the opportunity cost of starting in Q4 vs Q2?

Critical: Ask these questions in the Green Zone, not the Red Zone. By the time you're closing, it's too late to create urgency, you can only leverage it. *[page 51 of your book]*

Green Zone Play 2: Mutual Action Plan

A **Mutual Action Plan (MAP)** is a shared document that defines every step from current state to signature, with ownership and accountability on both sides. It's not a seller-driven timeline—it's a buying agreement.

What Makes a Strong MAP

Shared ownership: Both buyer and seller have responsibilities listed with names attached.

Business-driven dates: Every milestone is tied to a business reason, not an arbitrary calendar date.

Contingency planning: Identifies potential blockers and defines how to handle them before they occur.

Executive visibility: Economic buyer has reviewed and agreed to the plan, even if they're not executing tasks.

Living document: Updated after every conversation. Changes are discussed, not just accepted.

📌 **When to run this play:** In the Green Zone after you mutually agreed on fit (4F), identifying the key stakeholders, confirm their interest, and asked for permission. **Biggest mistake** – premature creation of the MAP.

SAMPLE Mutual Action Plan

Here's an example of a Mutual Action Plan, outlining key milestones, responsible parties, and deadlines. This shared document ensures both your team and the buyer are aligned and committed to the path forward.

MILESTONE / ACTION	OWNER	 DUE DATE	 STATUS	 DEPENDENCIES	 NOTES
Discovery Complete	(Buyer Name)	05/01	Not Started	IT Stakeholder	Initial pain & use case validated
ROI & Business Case Review	(Seller)	05/14	Not Started	Business Case	ROI shared, proposal in draft
Proposal Review	(Buyer/Seller)	05/21	Not Started		
Implementation Plan Review	(Seller)	06/01	Not Started		Implementation plan shared and reviewed with IT
Business Approval	(Buyer)	06/14	Not Started		Business committed to the project and signed off
Legal Review	(Buyer/Seller)	06/15	Not Started		Requires standard MSA
Final Approval	(Buyer)	06/30	Not Started	Needs ROI validation	
Agreement Signed	(Buyer/Seller)	06/30	Not Started		Agreement fully executed
Kickoff Scheduled	(Seller)	07/15	Not Started		Tentative calendar hold for onboarding
[Add Milestone]			Not Started		

Start w/ the end date (anchor to urgency date) and work backwards. This level of detail and shared accountability keeps deals moving and surfaces potential roadblocks early.

MAP for the win

Real statistics tell the truth on why you need to use a MAP!

26%

Increased Win Rate

deals where a **MAP was used** had **~26% higher win rates** than deals without one. (Outreach)

3-4X

Increased Win Rate

MAPs with **6-20 steps** provide the highest win rates in the **84%-92%** range for optimized MAPs. (trumpet)

Exercise: Build Your Mutual Action Play (MAP)

 **Pick a mid-funnel deal that's stalled or moving slowly.** Open the MAP Template. Let's turn interest into progress.

01

Define 5–6 key milestones

What has to happen between today and closed-won?

03

Add target dates

Get specific. When will each milestone complete?

02

Assign ownership

Who owns (buyer/seller) each milestone?

04

Note dependencies

What needs to happen first? What could block progress?

You have 15–20 minutes. Use the template and build something you can share with your buyer this week.

Green Zone Review: Does Your Buyer Agree?

"Which milestone creates real momentum and would your buyer agree this is the plan?"

The real test isn't whether you built a MAP. It's whether your buyer will co-sign it. If they won't commit to dates and actions, you don't have momentum—you have hope.

Let's hear it:

What is the realistic timeframe from first milestone to signed?

What are the most impactful milestones in your process?

Do you think you can get buy-in from someone with High Authority and High Influence?

Can you commit to using as part of the selling process?





Let's Get in the Red Zone
Closing Triangulation & Own the Close

Red Zone Overview

The Red Zone is when deals are almost closed. It's the final stage, like negotiations or getting signatures. Everyone feels the pressure, but top sellers handle it better.

What Average Sellers Do

- Stop asking questions.
- Trust the champion without checking.
- Wait for the customer to act.
- Fix problems only after they appear.
- Lose control at the most important time.

What Elite Sellers Do

- Keep control by staying organized.
- Check with everyone involved to ensure agreement.
- Find and fix problems before they become objections.
- Confirm what people will do.
- Close deals confidently, not just hoping.

Red Zone mindset: Control, clarity, confidence. Be direct. Ask tough questions. Confirm important details. Check every assumption to avoid problems with the deal.

Red Zone Play 1: Closing Triangulation

Late stage deals die quietly. Legal has questions. Procurement wants new terms. IT flags security concerns. You thought you were close now you're stuck. Closing Triangulation solves this by validating all stakeholders before you forecast the deal.



Legal

Who reviews contracts? What redlines are non-negotiable? Have you spoken to them directly?



Procurement

Do they control vendor selection or just process POs? What's their approval timeline?



IT / Security

What security or technical review is required? Who signs off—and have you met them yet?

Timing: Use this play in the Red Zone at pre-verbal or just after verbal stage. Focus your top 3 stakeholders in the buying process.

Closing Triangulation: Proactively Removing Objections

This play tests buyer commitment, and proactively clears potential blockers before the final close.



Validate Internal Approvals

Work with your Champion to confirm all necessary sign-offs from Economic Buyer, Legal, Procurement, IT, and Finance or your defined Key Stakeholders.



Use "If-Then" Closing Language

Test buyer commitment by crafting conditional closes: "If we clear [X], can you sign by [Y]?" Uncover hesitation early.



Pre-Mortem with Your Champion

Ask, "What would cause this deal to fail?" to uncover potential roadblocks like stakeholder misalignment, budget issues, or lack of urgency.

By systematically addressing these areas, you ensure every step required to sign the deal is known and planned for.



Test Intent with If–Then Closes

Don't assume the deal is real. Test it. Use **If–Then intent questions** to validate commitment and smoke out hidden blockers.

- "If we address the security requirements by Friday, can we get this signed next week?"
- "If Legal approves the redlines, are there any other approvals we need?"
- "If we hit the delivery timeline you need, is there anything else that would stop this from moving forward?"

Their answers reveal whether you're close or just hopeful.

Inquisitive for the win

Real statistics tell the truth on why curiosity wins!

64%

Fail to ask for Commitment

and an even larger percentage struggle to uncover and resolve objections effectively.

40%

Ask more Questions

Top Reps Ask about **40% more questions** during discovery and about **30% more questions** during later stages compared to average reps

Red Zone Play 2: Own the Close™

"You don't 'hope' to close. You decide to close. The Red Zone is where deals are won or lost."

Purpose

Own the final 20 yards. This play eliminates last-minute surprises, hidden stakeholders, and silent deal killers. It ensures you stay in control from verbal commitment to signature.

When to Run It

Run this play when:

- The buyer has verbally committed
- The proposal is out
- The deal is in decision stage
- You are inside the final approval process

This is the moment where most deals stall.

What This Play Does



Map the Real Approval Path

Identify every person who signs, approves, or reviews before the deal closes.



Expose Hidden Risks

Surface the blockers, gaps, and unknowns before they derail the deal.



Pressure-Test Stakeholder Alignment

Confirm every key player is aligned and no silent opposition remains.



Lock Timeline & Next Steps

Assign owners and dates to every milestone between now and signature.



Build a Clear Path to Signature

Turn verbal commitment into a documented, executable close plan.

"No guessing. No waiting. No 'checking in.' You either control the close or the deal controls you."

Exercise: Own the Close

1

Pick a Real Deal

Choose a live opportunity in decision stage, proposal out, expected to close this quarter, or feels "at risk."

If it makes you uncomfortable—that's the right one.

2

Complete the Scorecard

Rate your deal 1–5 on:

- Stakeholder Alignment
- ROI Clarity
- Urgency
- Competitive Positioning
- Procurement Readiness
- Decision Confidence

Be honest. Optimism kills accuracy.

3

Diagnose the Real Risk

- What's the biggest risk to close?
- What conversation are you avoiding?
- What question haven't you asked?
- If this slips, why will it slip?

4

Build the 72-Hour Action Plan

Leave with:

- One decisive conversation scheduled
- One urgency driver activated
- One risk neutralized
- One commitment question asked

📌 **"Final Rule: You are not allowed to leave with a 'wait and see' plan. You either close it or disqualify it. That's how elite sellers operate in the Red Zone."**

Deal Breakdown Exercise

This is where real coaching happens. We pick one struggling deal and dig in with curiosity, not judgment. 6 deals in one hour!

1

Deal Basics

Size, stage, target close

2

Core Problem

And its urgency

3

Key Stakeholders

Who's in, who's missing

4

Roadblocks & Gaps

What's holding us back

5

Path Forward

Actionable next steps

The goal is clarity. Once we see the truth, the next move becomes obvious.

Workshop Wrap-Up: What Elite Sellers Do Differently

Red Zone Selling isn't about working harder—it's about executing with structure when pressure is highest. Elite sellers don't rely on hope, luck, or champion promises. They run plays, confirm assumptions, and maintain control through every zone.

Yellow Zone Discipline

Disqualify fast. Invest only in deals with strong 4Fs. Multi-thread early before you need it.

Green Zone Momentum

Build MAPs, not timelines. Create urgency through friction, not pressure. Get buyer commitment before investing resources.

Red Zone Control

Triangulate alignment across all stakeholders. Sweep objections before they surface. Confirm instead of assume. Close with confidence.

Your Call to Action

- Apply these plays to your pipeline **this week**—starting with your weakest deals
- Pressure-test every deal using the frameworks: 4F, Power Map, MAP, Triangulation
- Run plays by zone, not by habit—the play that works in Yellow fails in Red
- Coach each other—share wins, losses, and lessons learned as you execute

Remember: Under pressure, you don't rise to the occasion—you fall to your level of training. Master the plays now so you execute with confidence when it matters most.

Free Red Zone Coaching Offer

3 Months Free Access

Unlock Your Full Sales Potential with Our Comprehensive Red Zone Coaching Program

Gain exclusive access to a powerful combination of expert-led strategies, advanced tools, and a supportive community designed to accelerate your sales performance and help you close more deals.

- **Accelerate Your Growth:** Master cutting-edge sales techniques and tactics to achieve your targets faster.
- **Benefit from Expert Guidance:** Participate in weekly office hours and monthly masterclasses for direct insights from top performers.
- **Access a Thriving Community:** Connect, collaborate, and get real-time support from like-minded sellers in our private channels.
- **Leverage AI-Powered Insights:** Utilize our AI Red Zone Coach for immediate, personalized advice on your deals.

Coupon Code: starter3free – [Register Now](#)

Thank you! Red Zone Selling

1

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Survey

Rate the **Workshop**



Vince Beese

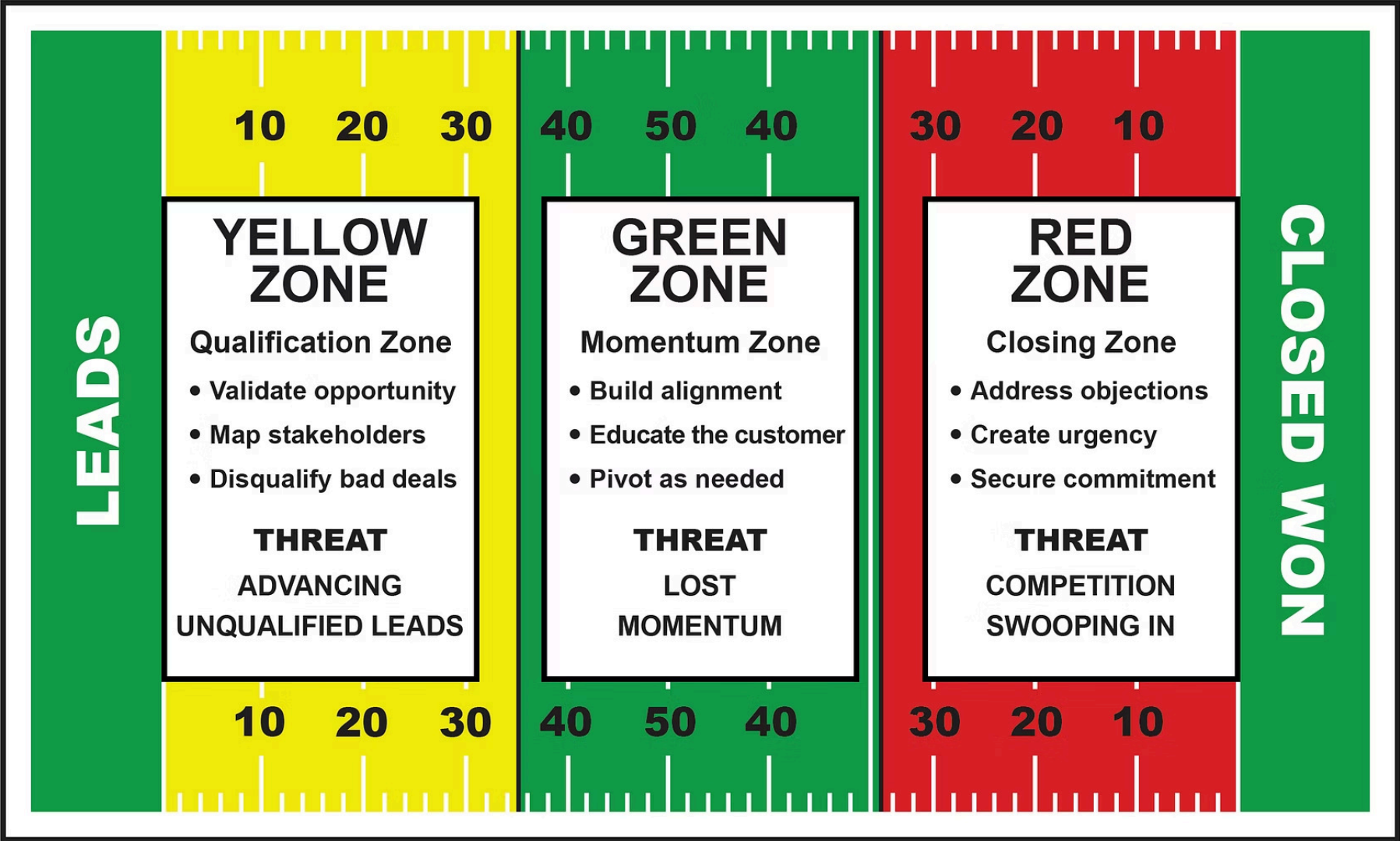
Helping Sales Organizations Drive
Scalable Growth & Higher Win Rate...



Appendix Slides

Red Zone Field of Play

RED ZONE PLAYBOOK



Red Zone Play: Final Objection Sweep

Surprises kill deals. The Final Objection Sweep eliminates last-minute blockers by proactively surfacing concerns before they become dealbreakers. Run this play 1-2 weeks before the expected close date.

1

Legal Objections

"Before we finalize, are there any contract terms or clauses that could cause delays in legal review?"

2

Security Objections

"Has your security team flagged any concerns about our platform, compliance, or data handling?"

3

Budget Objections

"Is there anything that could impact budget availability or require additional approval before we close?"

4

Timing Objections

"What could cause this timeline to slip on your side? What dependencies do you have that I don't know about?"

The key: Ask these questions when there's still time to solve the problem. If legal has concerns, you need weeks, not days. Frame objections as planning questions, not challenges to commitment.

Exercise: Validate Your Red Zone Deal

📌 **Pick your best late-stage deal.** Open the Closing Triangulation Template. Let's make sure this deal is real.

List all remaining approvals

Legal, Procurement, IT, Security, Finance—write down every stakeholder who could block this deal

Write one If–Then close

Craft a question that tests real intent and flushes out objections early

Run a pre-mortem

Assume the deal dies next week. What assumption or missed stakeholder killed it? Write it down.

You have 10 minutes. Then we'll share what risks surfaced.